

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Savanna transition map

EQUATORWARD -> wetter and taller grass

SUDAN BELT -> classic wet-dry savanna

POLEWARD -> shorter grass and open trees

DESERT MARGIN -> drought risk intensifies

MUST REMEMBER: Savanna Aw/As climates reflect seasonal ITCZ migration between convective wet summers and subtropical-high dry winters, sustaining tall grasses with scattered drought/fire-adapted trees across Africa, South America and northern Australia.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: ITCZ seasonal switch

HIGH-SUN SEASON -> ITCZ approaches

CONVERGENCE + CONVECTION -> summer rain

LOW-SUN SEASON -> dry trades dominate

RESULT -> hot wet / warm dry rhythm

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Water-reliability chain

LATE ONSET -> delayed sowing

MID-SEASON BREAK -> crop and forage stress

EARLY CESSATION -> incomplete grain filling

DROUGHT -> migration and herd loss risk

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Grass-tree gradient

WET MARGIN -> tall grass + more trees

CORE SAVANNA -> parkland mosaic

DRY MARGIN -> short grass + thorny shrubs

DESERT EDGE -> discontinuous vegetation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Fire-herbivory balance

SEASONAL RAIN -> grass biomass

DRY SEASON -> combustible fuel

FIRE + BROWSING -> seedling suppression

THICK BARK + ROOTS -> selected tree survival

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Wildlife-livelihood matrix

HERDS -> follow seasonal forage and water

PREDATORS -> track herbivore concentrations

PASTORALISTS -> mobility spreads risk

CULTIVATORS -> millet / sorghum timing

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Degradation pathway

COVER LOSS -> raindrop and wind exposure

WET SEASON -> runoff, leaching and erosion

DRY SEASON -> fire and surface sealing

FIXED WATER POINT -> local grazing concentration

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: India forest gradient

MOIST DECIDUOUS -> longer wet season

DRY DECIDUOUS -> stronger leaf-shedding

THORN / SCRUB -> semi-arid moisture stress

RULE -> overlapping belts, not fixed walls

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Indian grassland firewall

TERAI -> humid tall grass and floodplain
SHOLA -> montane grass-forest mosaic
BANNI -> arid-saline Kachchh grassland
MANAGEMENT -> hydrology and history first

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Restoration decision tree

NATURAL OPEN ECOSYSTEM -> conserve openness

DEGRADED SCRUB -> restore native mosaic

WATER PROCESS -> recharge and drainage

LIVELIHOOD -> grazing and tenure design

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Savanna is tropical grassland, steppe is semi-arid temperate/subtropical grassland, and parkland structure is not evidence of a climax maintained by climate alone because fire, herbivory and land use matter.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Savanna PYQ firewall

2021 PRELIMS -> tree-limiting conditions

CLIMATE -> long dry season

DISTURBANCE -> fire + herbivory

LEDGER -> no answer letter invented

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Fire can recycle nutrients and maintain openness but frequency/intensity changes may degrade systems; Indian deciduous forests and grasslands need region-specific rainfall, fire and grazing evidence rather than direct Sudan-type equivalence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Savanna answer spine

LOCATE -> rainforest-desert transition

DERIVE -> ITCZ and wet-dry season

EXPLAIN -> grass-tree disturbance balance

APPLY -> India mosaics and restoration